

**LABORATORY ACTIVITY NO. 3.3.13**

Playing the Audio

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This lab activity focuses on setting up and testing audio output devices on a Windows computer. The student will learn how to properly connect speakers or headphones, navigate to the system's sound configuration settings, test audio channels to ensure proper output, and control playback volume using the Windows interface. This lab provides a practical understanding of basic audio management within the operating system.

I. OBJECTIVES

Upon completion of this laboratory exercise, students are expected to and meet the following intended learning outcomes:

Activity Objectives	Intended Learning Outcomes		
	ILO1	ILO2	ILO3
1) successfully connect and configure audio output devices, such as speakers or headphones, using the sound settings available in Windows 11, including navigating to the classic Control Panel's "Sound" applet.	•	•	
2) effectively utilize Windows 11's sound configuration tools to test and verify multi-channel audio output, ensuring proper functionality of connected playback devices.	•	•	
3) gain proficiency in playing audio or video from online sources and adjusting playback volume using the taskbar controls and other relevant audio management features within the Windows 11 environment.	•	•	

Where:

- ILO1 – Exhibit thorough demonstration of the concept
- ILO2 – Being able to perform the activity independently
- ILO3 – Design and evaluate emerging IT solutions

II. DISCUSSION



- **Device Setup:** This includes the installation and uninstallation of peripherals, emphasizing the role of Plug-and-Play (PnP) and device drivers in this process.
- **Display Devices:** The module covers different display technologies such as LCD, LED, OLED, and Plasma. It also details key display characteristics like refresh rate, resolution, aspect ratio, brightness, contrast ratio, and response time, along with the configuration of multiple displays.
- **Multimedia Devices:** Discussions include sound devices (sound cards, speakers, headphones, and microphones), as well as webcams and video cameras.
- **Printers:** Various types of printers are covered, including inkjet, laser, thermal, and impact printers. Key features such as duplexing, speed, color capabilities, and memory are discussed. Maintenance aspects like ink/toner replacement, calibration, and cleaning are also included, along with different printer interfaces (USB, Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth).
- **Scanners:** The document describes flatbed and sheet-fed scanner types. It also covers the process of scanning documents, mentioning interfaces like TWAIN and Windows Image Acquisition (WIA), and common output file formats such as JPG, TIFF, PDF, and the use of Optical Character Recognition (OCR).
- **Digital Cameras:** The module touches upon digital cameras and methods for transferring images from cameras to a PC.

III. MATERIALS

A Windows 11 installed computer system.

IV. PROCEDURE

For this activity, you will execute the provided step-by-step instructions. As you complete each step, capture a screenshot of the resulting output or completed action that directly demonstrates successful execution of that instruction. Paste each screenshot into the designated area within your lab document.

Important Considerations:

- **Connecting Audio Devices:** Ensure your speakers or headphones are correctly plugged into the appropriate audio output jack on your computer before starting the lab. Refer to your system documentation if you are unsure which port to use.
- **Accessing Sound Settings in Windows 11:**
 - The lab specifically guides you to use the **Control Panel**. In Windows 11, you can access the Control Panel by clicking the **Start button**, typing "Control Panel" in the search bar, and selecting it from the results. Once in the Control Panel, you can use the search box to find "Sound".

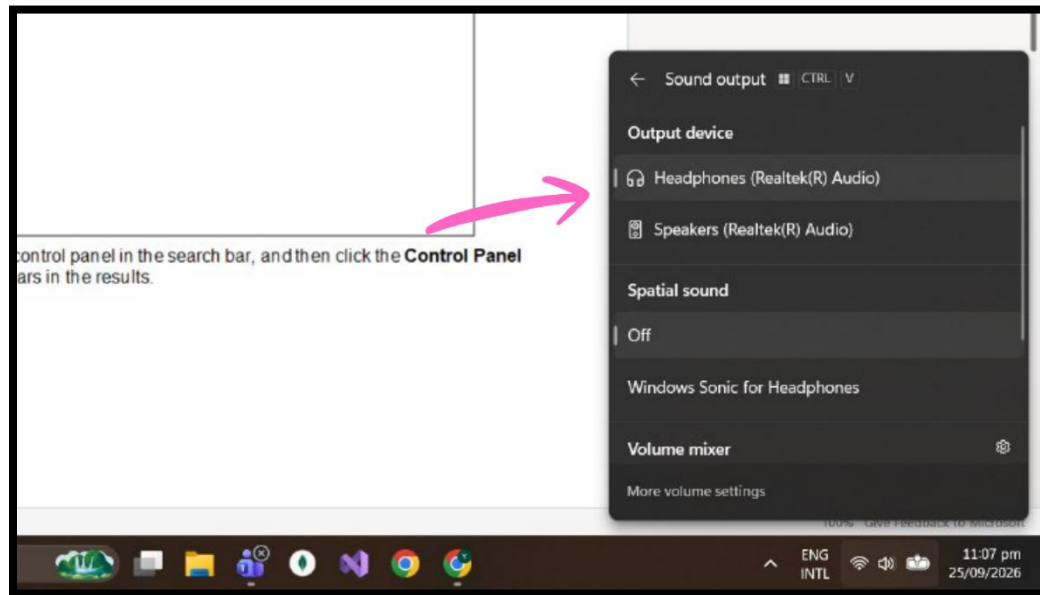


- **Alternative (Modern Settings App):** While the lab uses the Control Panel, in Windows 11, many audio settings are also available via the modern **Settings app**. You can right-click the **Start button** and select **Settings**, then navigate to **System > Sound**. This interface provides a more streamlined way to manage output devices, adjust master volume, and access "More sound settings" which typically links to the classic Control Panel Sound dialog. For this lab, adhere to the Control Panel steps as outlined.
- **Configuring and Testing Speakers:** The "Sound" applet within the Control Panel (under the Playback tab) is where you will configure and test your connected speakers or headphones. The steps for selecting your device, clicking "Configure," and performing a test should be consistent in Windows 11.
- **Adjusting Volume:** Adjusting the volume using the icon on the taskbar is a standard Windows feature that functions identically in Windows 11 as in previous versions.
- **Online Audio Source:** The lab provides a specific URL for testing audio playback. While this URL is for demonstration purposes, in a real-world scenario, you would typically use a live online video or audio streaming service (like YouTube) or a local media file to test your audio output.

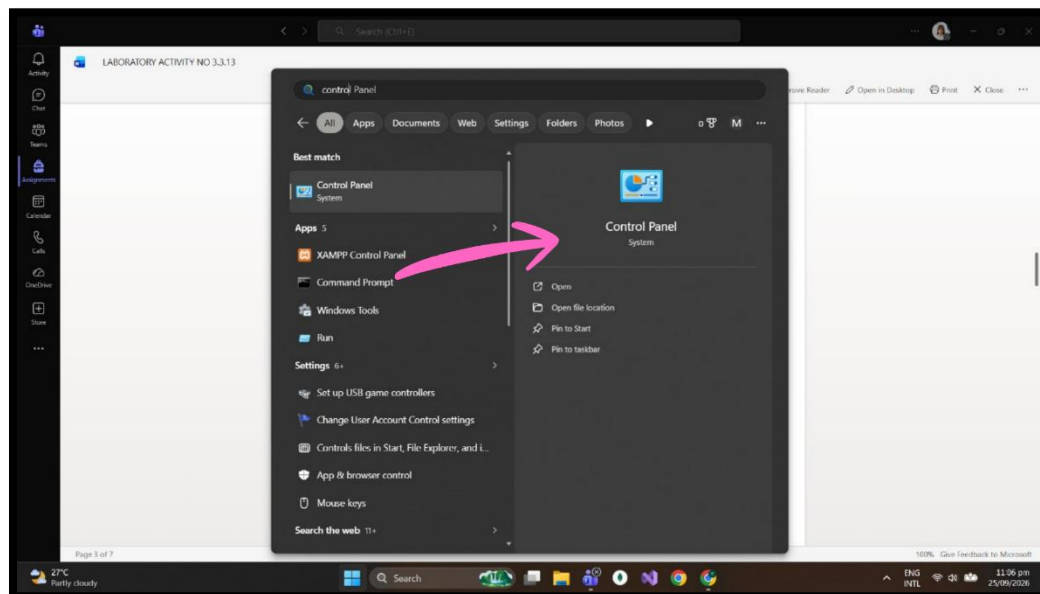


Steps:

1. Referring to the system documentation if necessary, connect the speakers or a pair of headphones to the appropriate audio output jack on your computer.

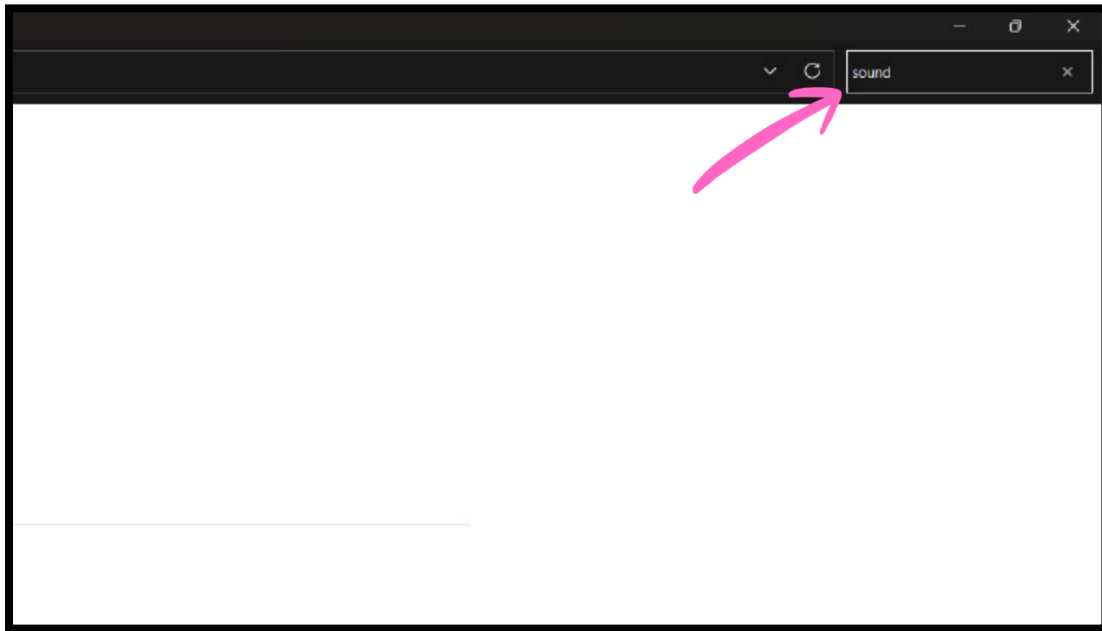


2. Click **Start**, type control panel in the search bar, and then click the **Control Panel** app when it appears in the results.

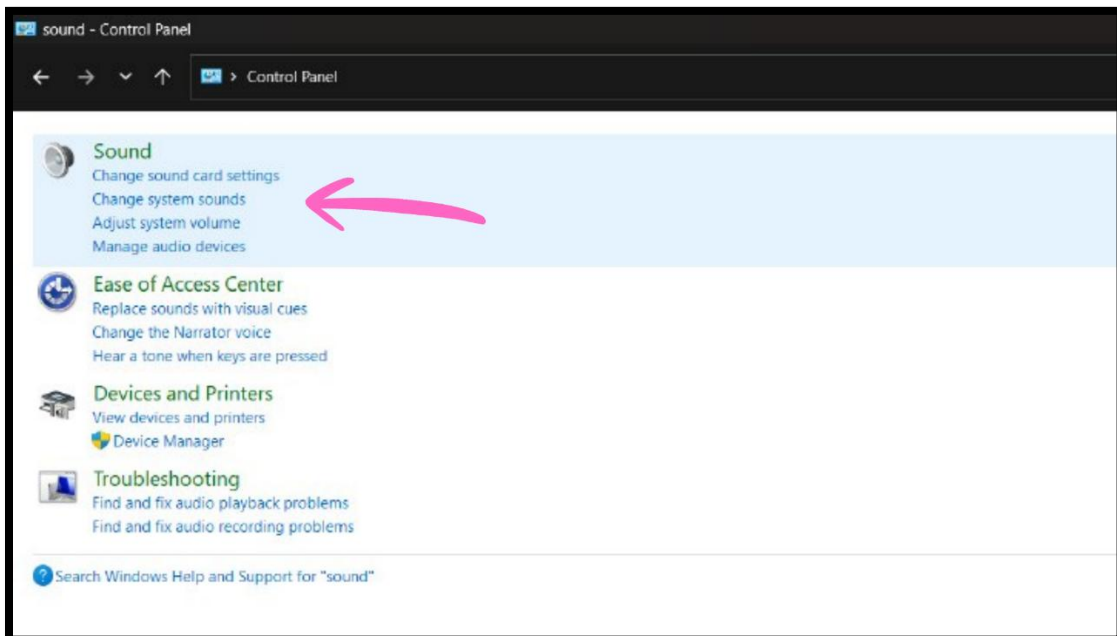




3. In the Control Panel's "Search" box (top-right corner), type sound.

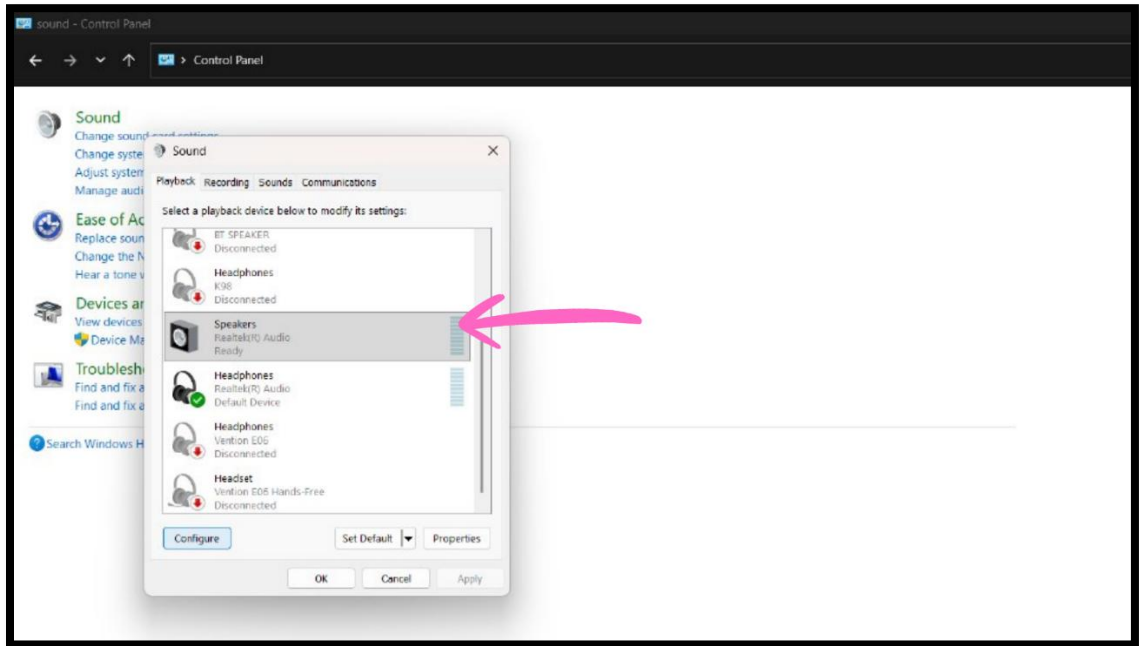


4. Click the **Sound** applet from the list of results.

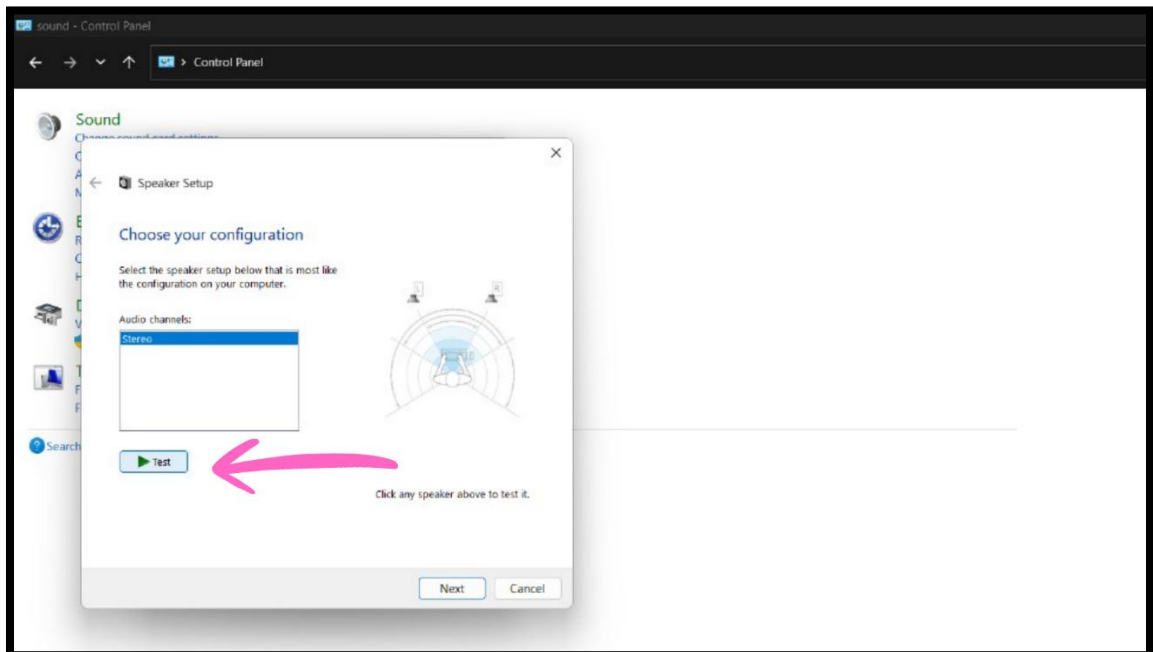




5. On the **Playback** tab, select your speakers (or headphones if that's what you connected) then click the **Configure** button.

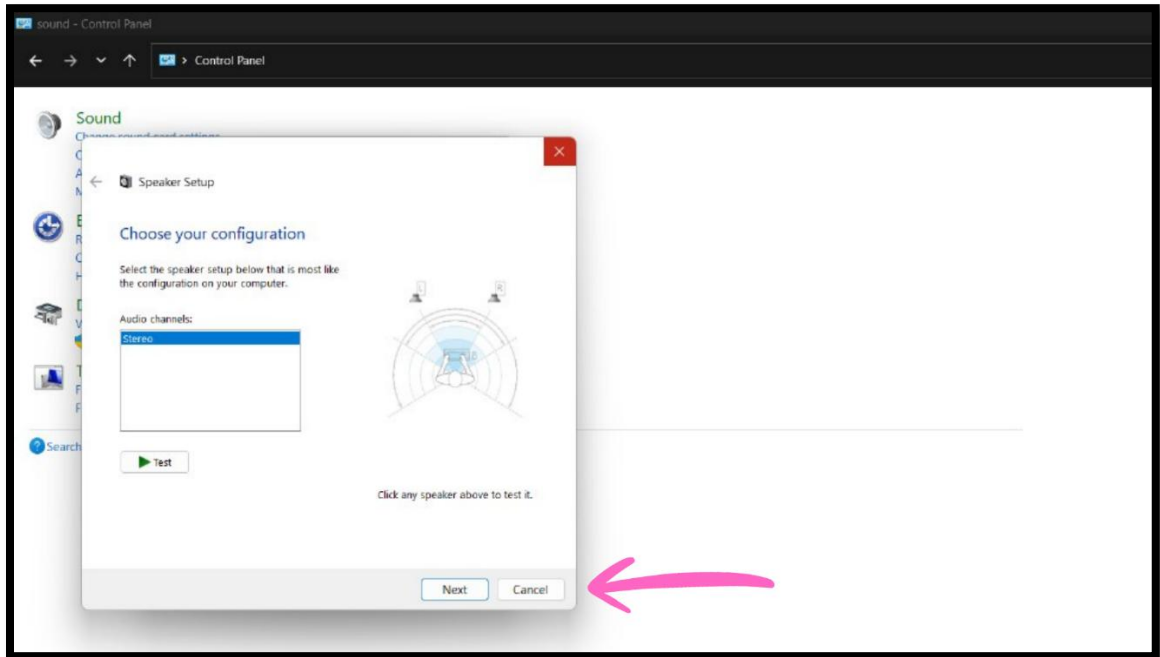


6. Click **Test** – you should hear a sound from first one speaker then the other (if configured for stereo or surround sound).

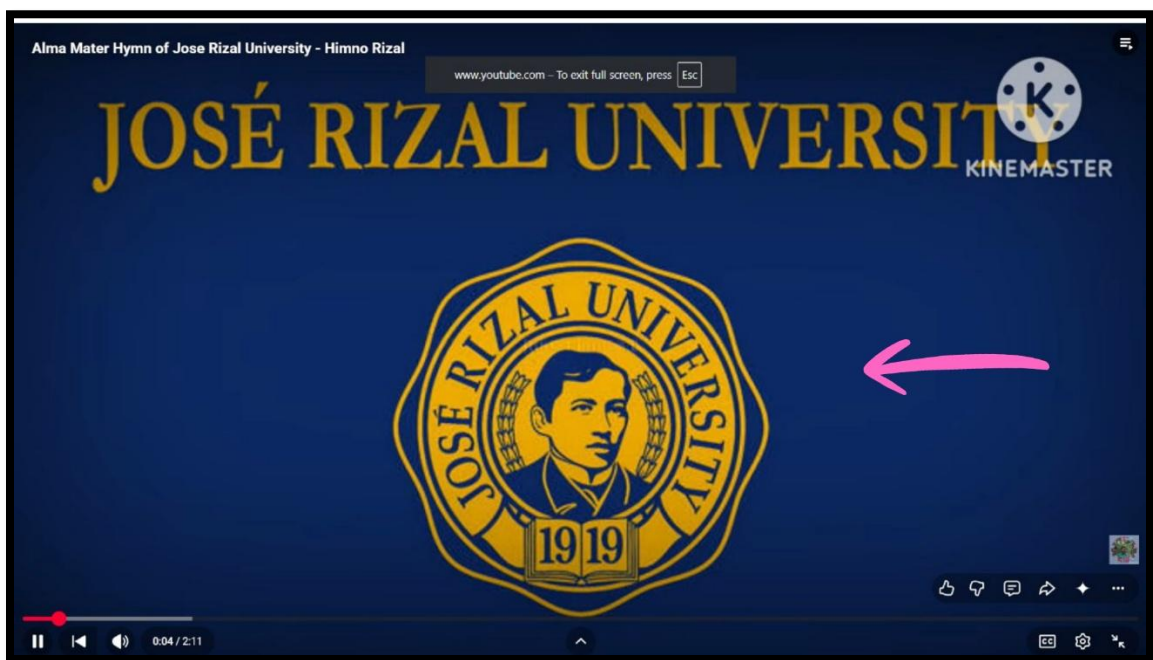




7. Click **Cancel** or **OK** to close the configuration dialogs, then close the "Sound" applet window.

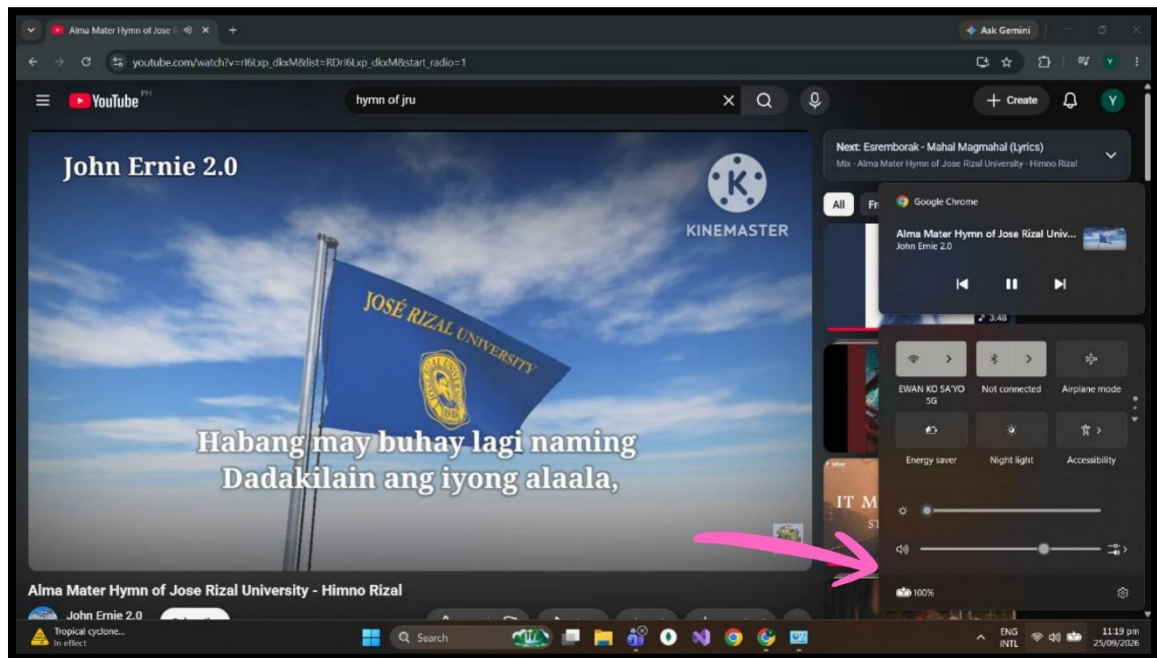


8. Open your web browser. Type the following URL into the address bar then press **ENTER**: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0luCHpUgj7k>

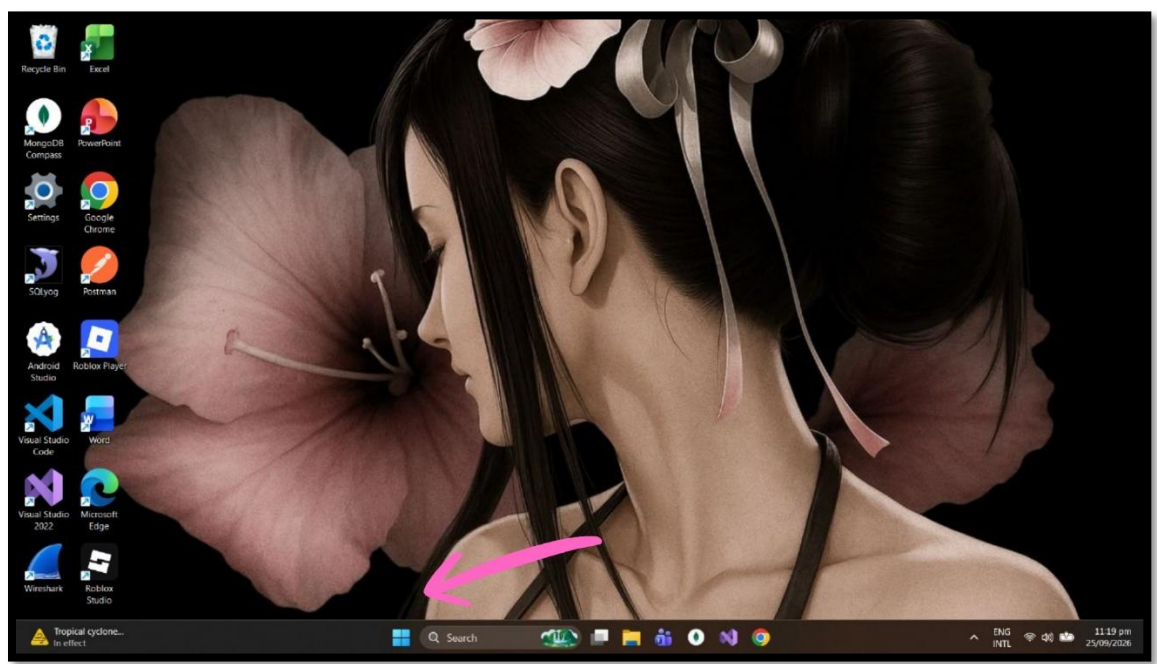




9. Press **Play** to start the video. As it plays, try adjusting the volume using the **speaker icon** (volume control) on the taskbar.



10. Optionally, shut down your computer if you are not continuing to use it after this lab.





V. REFLECTION:

Upon successful completion of "Lab 3.3.13: Playing the Audio," write a comprehensive reflection (between 150-250 words) addressing the following points:

- **Learning Outcomes:** What new knowledge or skills did you acquire or reinforce regarding the playing of audio?
- **Challenges and Solutions:** Describe any difficulties or unexpected issues you encountered during the lab. How did you overcome them, or what steps would you take to resolve them in the future?
- **Real-world Relevance:** How do the skills and understanding gained in this lab relate to real-world scenarios, either in your personal life or a professional IT context?
- **Critical Thinking:** If you had to use an internet image for any step, explain why you couldn't perform the action physically and how finding the image contributed to your understanding.

In this lab activity, I learned how to connect, configure, and test audio devices in Windows 11 using the Control Panel Sound settings and taskbar volume controls.

When I struggled to identify the correct audio device and port connection, I learned to resolve the issue by verifying physical connections, checking volume levels, and confirming the selected playback device in the settings.

These troubleshooting skills are practical for resolving common day-to-day audio issues and will help me as an IT student when assisting others. Overall, the activity improved my understanding of Windows 11 audio management and built my confidence in basic hardware troubleshooting.